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THURSDAY JANUARY 23, 2025
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WAM

PRESIDENT, VICE-PRESIDENT DISCUSS NATION'S GROWTH PLANS

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday. During the meeting at Qasr Al Rawdah in Al Ain, the leaders explored strategies to further the UAE's ambitious development agenda and accelerate the achievement of its national objectives.

Jumeirah steps up plans to expand global presence

Hospitality leader also sets target to strengthen Dubai portfolio

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai Holdings' Jumeirah is set to expand its global footprint in 2025, with plans to grow in Europe, Asia, and the US while bolstering its presence in Dubai and Saudi Arabia, according to its recently-appointed CEO Thomas Meier.

The group will also launch the highly anticipated Jumeirah Marsa Al Arab in Dubai

early this year, debuting its new visual brand identity.

"We currently manage 30 hotels, and we have ambitious plans to double our portfolio by 2030 with significant investments to evolve our guest experience," said Meier.

In Europe, the group is renovating Jumeirah Le Richemond in Switzerland, set to open in 2027, as part of its focus on ultra-luxury offerings in strategic cities like Geneva.

"Strategic gateway cities

30

number of hotels managed by Dubai Holdings' Jumeirah

like Geneva are important as they help us build the Jumeirah brand amongst a wider audience – both business and leisure – and serve as an entry point to mountain destinations for dual centre experiences," explained Meier.

Closer to home, the group plans to expand in Saudi Arabia following the 2023 launch of Jumeirah Jabal Omar Makkah, with Jumeirah Red Sea set to open soon.

Last year, Jumeirah also made its African debut with Jumeirah Thanda Island in Tanzania and Jumeirah Thanda Safari in South Africa, offering exclusive experiences rooted in culture and connection.

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Jenin reels from heavy Israeli air raid

GOVERNOR SAYS 'SITUATION VERY DIFFICULT' AS 2,000 FAMILIES DISPLACED

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

Israeli forces yesterday intensified its raid on West Bank town of Jenin that the military described as a "counterterrorism" operation.

The Israeli military said it had "hit over 10 terrorists". "Additionally, aerial strikes on terror infrastructure sites were conducted and numerous explosives planted on the routes by the terrorists were dismantled," it said in a statement yesterday. "The Israeli forces are continuing the operation."

"The situation is very difficult," Kamal Abu Al Rub, the governor of Jenin, told AFP.

"The occupation army has bulldozed all the roads leading to the Jenin camp, and leading to the Jenin Governmental Hospital... There is shooting and explosions," he added.

According to Arab media reports, Israeli forces destroyed infrastructure and forced the displacement of about 2,000 families.

On Tuesday, Israeli forces launched an operation in Jenin which Palestinian officials said

killed 10 people, just days after a ceasefire between Israel and Hamas took effect in the Gaza Strip.

According to Abu Al Rub, Israeli forces detained around 20 people from villages near Jenin.

'Decisive operation'

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz vowed to continue the assault. "It is a decisive operation aimed at eliminating terrorists in the camp," Katz said yesterday adding that the military would not allow a "terror front" to be established there.

On Tuesday, the Israeli military and the Shin Bet security agency announced that, in coordination with the Border Police, they had launched an operation named "Iron Wall" in the area.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the raid aimed to "eradicate terrorism" in Jenin.

He linked the operation to a broader strategy of countering Iran "wherever it sends its arms – in Gaza, Lebanon, Syria, Yemen," and the West Bank.

According to the Palestinian health ministry, Israeli troops or settlers have killed at least 848 Palestinians in the West Bank since the Gaza conflict began.

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Solo night marathon with a message

Dubai woman aims to dispel misconceptions about safety in city

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Lily Collyer, a 26-year-old British expat and fitness trainer, recently went the extra mile, literally, by running a full solo marathon on Dubai's streets in the middle of the night with a special goal – to challenge misconceptions about women's safety in the emirate and inspire others with her positive experiences as a solo female runner.

Since moving to Dubai three years ago, Collyer has taken on extreme challenges, including an ultramarathon, a 100km run from Abu Dhabi to Dubai, and even a 24-



hour burpee challenge. However, the night marathon was more than a personal milestone. "The reason I wanted to send out such a meaningful message is because I believe there is a misconception of Dubai as a place where women might feel restricted or unsafe, but my experience has been quite the opposite," Collyer told Gulf News.

"I feel there are many women all over the world who definitely wouldn't feel this free or confident to roam the streets in the middle of the night."

Her 42km run from 2am lasted for about five hours.

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SPORT

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